

Participant Information Sheet (PR/002):

BrainPower is a hybrid, multi-modal, Automated Essay Scoring (AES) system which orchestrates three pre-trained AI models

- 1) **Optical Character Recognition (OCR)** model– to extract handwritten essays and convert them to digital text
- 2) **Speech-To-Text (STT)** model – transcribe spoken essays and convert them to digital text
- 3) **Transformer** model – to evaluate and provide a holistic score for an essay supplied as digital text

to provide accessibility for students and interpretability, readability and automation in support of human scorers.

Thank you for your interest in this research project. Your participation is very much appreciated. This Participant Information Sheet explains what will happen if you choose to take part in this evaluation study.

What is the evaluation for?

Your handwritten text and voice recording will be used to evaluate the performance as well as the suitability of the OCR and STT models for inclusion in the system.

What will I be asked to do if I participate?

- 1) Copy an essay in your handwriting and submit an image of it for processing
- 2) Submit a recording of your voice reading your handwritten essay for processing

What will happen to the information I provide?

The evaluation may be used in:

- a) Essay image – Optical Character Recognition – the handwritten text will be extracted and converted to digital text for processing
- b) Your audio voice recording will be transcribed – converted to digital text and processed

You can clarify on the Participant Consent form (PR/001) whether you consent to your identifiable information (name / organisation / position) to be included in the project report.

This identifiable information (your “personal data”) will be stored securely by the principal project researcher.

Your data will be held for up to six months after the end of the project (expected September 28, 2026), and then securely destroyed. You can request a copy of your data at any time before this date.

What if I have any questions relating to my data or want to withdraw my personal data?

You can send any questions relating to the processing of your data or request to withdraw your personal data by contacting **asadorville@gmail.com**.

If you have any concerns about the processing of your personal data or your information rights, please see the [University's data protection web pages](#). Or contact the Data Protection Officer: dp@gold.ac.uk

You can also contact the Information Commissioners' Office – <https://ico.org.uk> – in relation to any concerns or issue you may have with the processing of your personal information.